



Above Drummers parade at Port of Spain's colorful five-day pre-Lenten Carnival

Left Trinidad has many produce markets selling fresh fruits, vegetables, and meat (including live chickens), visited by locals early each morning



Above Roti, especially in the form of *dosti*, is often eaten in the form of a wrap filled with seafood, chicken, or vegetable curry

Food Markets

Trinidad's multicultural ancestry is easily identified in Port of Spain's noisy Central Market, where you can rummage through piles of fresh-plucked dasheen leaves, succulent okra, water chestnuts, yucca, and bunches of blood-red chili peppers, and breathe in the intoxicating aroma of coconut milk sprinkled with crab meat, cilantro, or thyme. Nibble on richly seasoned, fried chunks of *geera* pork and tender pig's trotters, or glug down generous cups of corn soup topped off with a cloudlike dumpling, as hordes of food shoppers from all creeds jostle for paper-wrapped bargains around the seller's weighing scale.

The Best Places to Eat Roti

Siparia-Erin Road

To feast on a wide range of delectable roti, head to the Siparia-Erin Road in Debe, Port of Spain, where Trinidad's huge Indian community is centered. Dozens of vendors ply their mouthwatering wares at red-hot roadside *tawas* (griddles) that sizzle and spit with curried lentils, chickpeas, meat, shrimp, and strips of spicy vegetables. Choose from cold prewrapped rotis or freshly cooked warm breads on which to ladle generous dollops of filling, with a spoonful of piquant sauce on the side. With bare fingers, rip the flaky, buttery roti apart to delight in peppery beans, sweet tomatoes, sautéed *baigan* (eggplant), and lightly spiced spinach bhaji.

Also in Port of Spain

Other exquisite rotis can be found in the district of Penal, where Indian-owned curbside huts sell candied delicacies, hot spicy snacks, and sweets along Main Street. Imbibe the aromatic temptations of a host of scrumptious nibbles such as fried potato pies, *pholourie* (fried balls of ground split peas served with chutney), *barfi* (coconut fudge), *goolab jamoom* (milk balls in sweet syrup), and piles of roti stacked under towels to keep them perfectly moist and warm.

Also in Trinidad

D'Roti Hut (868 681 8717; *inexpensive*) on Eastern Main Road, Sangre Grande, in Trinidad's northeast, is a low-key, fast-food carry-out joint, but its menu offers about half a dozen mouthwatering variants to street stand food. Staff here use the local lingo when it comes to roti talk, and when you "buy roti" it means committing to a dish of curried vegetables, lentils, or meats wrapped up burrito-style in buttery griddle-cooked bread – unless you order a "buss-up-shot," in which the meat or vegetables are served on the side. D'Roti Hut is reliably good and everyone knows it.

Around the World

At **Roti Houpa** (+44 20 7627 8637; *inexpensive*) on Clapham High Street in South London, a highly skilled team of roti-makers hail from Debe and Penal's huge Indo-Trinidadian community. You can watch these roti masters at work as you peruse a carry-out menu of authentic Indo-Trinidadian cuisine. Also in London, the **Trinidad Roti Shop** (+44 20 8838 4800; *inexpensive*) on Nicoll Road, Harlesden, is unmissable, as it boasts a Trinidadian flag the size of a family car. Run by a friendly family from Port of Spain, this delightful red-and-white-painted hole-in-the-wall is a snug fit when it's busy. Join a line that often snakes out of the door to witness your order being fulfilled at a rhythmic pace. Choose from curried potato fillings and spicy sauces from a menu of sweet and savory rotis.